

Marx: politics and the inevitability of socialism

Before writing his massive book, *Das Kapital*, Marx had been a co-author with Friedrich Engels of the *Communist Manifesto*, in which he explains that capitalism contains within it the seeds of its own destruction. Because capitalism has created two classes, the business-owning bourgeoisie and the labouring proletariat, the tension between them will inevitably result in social and economic change. In the words of the *Manifesto*, 'What the bourgeoisie produces above all is its own grave diggers', meaning that capitalism has created the conditions for a conflict in which the proletariat will seize ownership of the means of production, and change the 'dictatorship of the bourgeoisie' to a 'dictatorship of the proletariat' run on socialist economic and social principles. But this is, Marx says, only a transitional stage to the ultimate conclusion of historical development, communism – a classless society that brings to an end the historical conflict between classes, and in which private property and the state itself no longer exist.



M a n i f e s t

der

Kommunistischen Partei.

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